

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦ 6

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ 3

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠ J

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ Q 7 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ A K 10 6 2

♥ A 4 3

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ 7



♠ 9 7
♥ J 10 9 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q 9 4

♠ Q 5 4 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A J 10 3

♣ 6 5 2

NORTH's 3♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has excellent help in ♦s so with 8 points he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♦

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♥J

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 3
♥ A Q J 7
♦ J 9
♣ K 10 2

♠ 9 7 6 2
♥ 9 8 2
♦ A 10 5 3
♣ J 5



♠ A 10 5
♥ 10 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ A 8 6 3

♠ K 4
♥ K 6 5 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ Q 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Pass
1 ♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♦ 6			

WEST has no reason to consider New Minor Forcing with this hand.

EAST does not have four ♥s or he would have already supported, and he does not have four ♠s or he would not have bid 1NT.

So WEST should bid the Notrump game.

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ A 6 3 2
♦ Q J 7
♣ K 8 7 3

♠ K 6 4
♥ K Q 9 7 4
♦ 4

♣ A J 6 5



♠ J 10 5
♥ J 10
♦ K 10 8 5 3 2
♣ 9 2

♠ A Q 9 7 2
♥ 8 5
♦ A 9 6
♣ Q 10 4

SOUTH might well bid 3NT at his second turn, and this may turn out to be the final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2♦ (Fourth Suit Forcing) just to see if NORTH happens to have three ♠s. She does, so 4♠ becomes the better game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q J 9 7
 ♦ A Q 9
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ J 10
 ♥ 6 3 2
 ♦ 10 8 7
 ♣ K J 10 7 6



♠ A K 7 6 3
 ♥ K 10 8 4
 ♦ K 4
 ♣ 5 2

♠ Q 9 4 2
 ♥ A 5
 ♦ J 6 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥	
All Pass			
4 ♥ by West			
Lead: ♠ J			

WEST isn't strong enough to make a Reverse bid of 2 ♥ at his second turn.

EAST uses the 2 ♦ (NMF) bid to ask WEST for further description. WEST should first show a 4-card ♥ suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Change WEST's ♥ 9 to the ♠ 9 and the contract would be 4 ♠.